EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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Aim

To demonstrate the development-to-production deployment workflow of a Zoho Creator application using the Environments feature, and to manage a multi-stage pipeline of isolated sandboxes (Development, Stage and Production) so that changes are built, tested and released in a controlled manner.

Introduction to Multi-Stage Deployment

Zoho Creator provides an Environments feature, described on its page as a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish an application without affecting the production. Each environment is a separate, isolated copy of the application hosted in the cloud, with its own version of the forms, reports, workflows and data. A change made in one environment does not reach the next until it is deliberately deployed. An application passes through three environments:

Environment	Purpose
Development	The sandbox in which the application is built, configured and changed. Changes made here do not reach applicants.
Stage	An intermediate testing environment, a replica of the release candidate, in which the application is deployed, tested and approved before release.
Production	The live environment in which the tested application is published and used by applicants and the admissions office.

Why isolated workspaces matter

Because the three environments are isolated, unfinished or unverified work can never disturb the live application. Structural changes such as new fields, altered validation, rewritten workflows or changed permissions are first made in Development, where a failure affects only the developer. The change is then promoted to Stage, where it is tested against realistic conditions without touching real applicants. Only after it is approved is it published to Production. This protects the active admission cycle from system downtime, broken application forms, lost or corrupted submissions and unverified structural changes, and keeps every release controlled, traceable and reversible through Version History.

Application Used

Student Admission Portal – an application to manage student applications and admissions for the academic year, covering applicant details, course preferences, document submission and admission status.

Procedure

The deployment follows the flow: Development Environment → Stage Environment → Production Environment.

Note: *Figures 11.1 to 11.4 are illustrative views of the Zoho Creator interface for the Student Admission application, used to demonstrate the deployment workflow; the statuses and dates in them are as displayed in the illustration.*

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator. The home page shows the Student Admission application. The left panel is divided into the groups DEVELOP, DEPLOY and MANAGE; the DEPLOY group contains the Environments, Mobile and Portal options. The Environments option is used for deploying applications across environments.

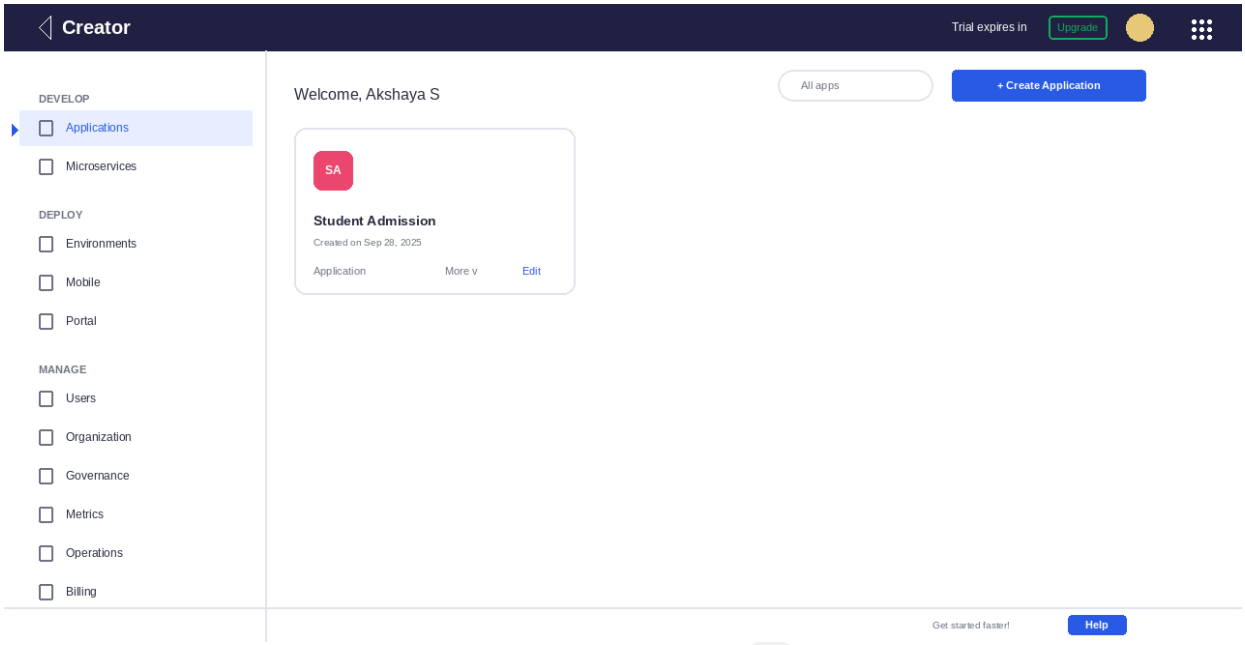


Figure 11.1: Zoho Creator Home – Student Admission Application and the DEPLOY → Environments Option

2. Select **Environments** under DEPLOY. The Environments page opens with the description "Multi-stage deployment space to test and publish your application without affecting the production", and with the Version History, Manage and Publish options at the top. The Stage and Production environments are shown as separate columns. Initially the message "There are no applications added to the environment" is shown in the left panel, and the columns display "No applications in Stage yet" and "No applications in Production yet". An **Add Application** button is provided.

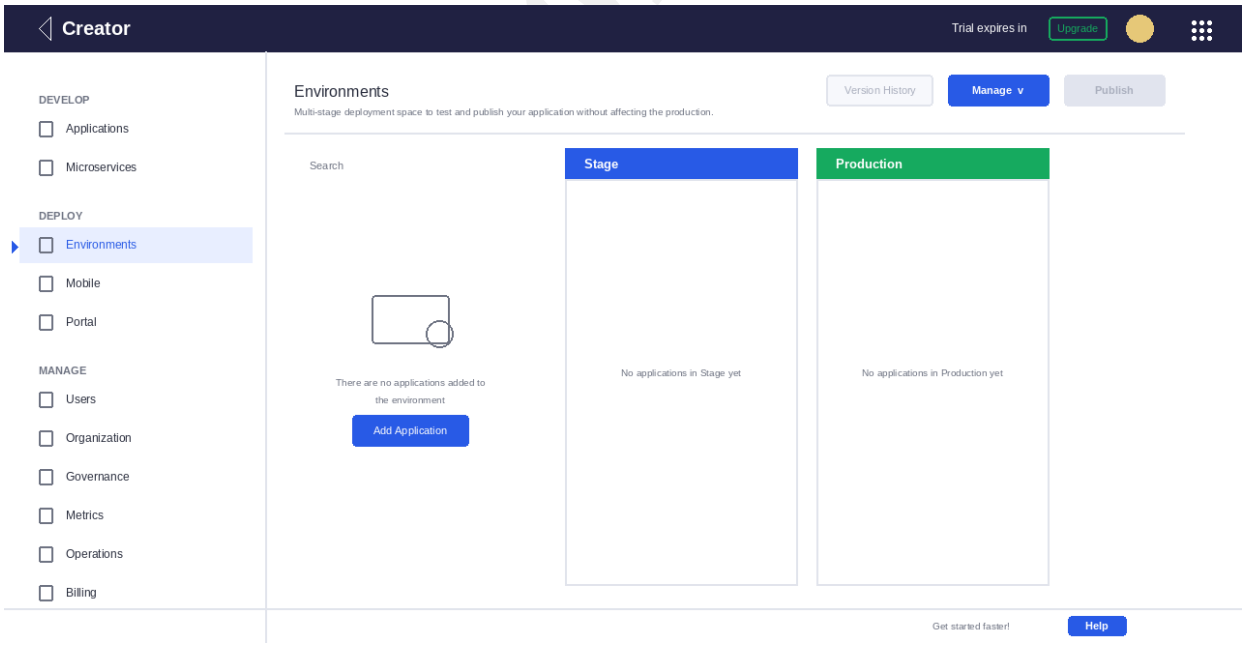


Figure 11.2: Environments Page – Stage and Production Environments (Empty)

3. Select **Add Application** and add the Student Admission application to the environment. The application now appears in the left panel with the status "No changes available", and version **1.0** is listed under both the Stage and Production columns. The Version History, Manage and Publish options become active.

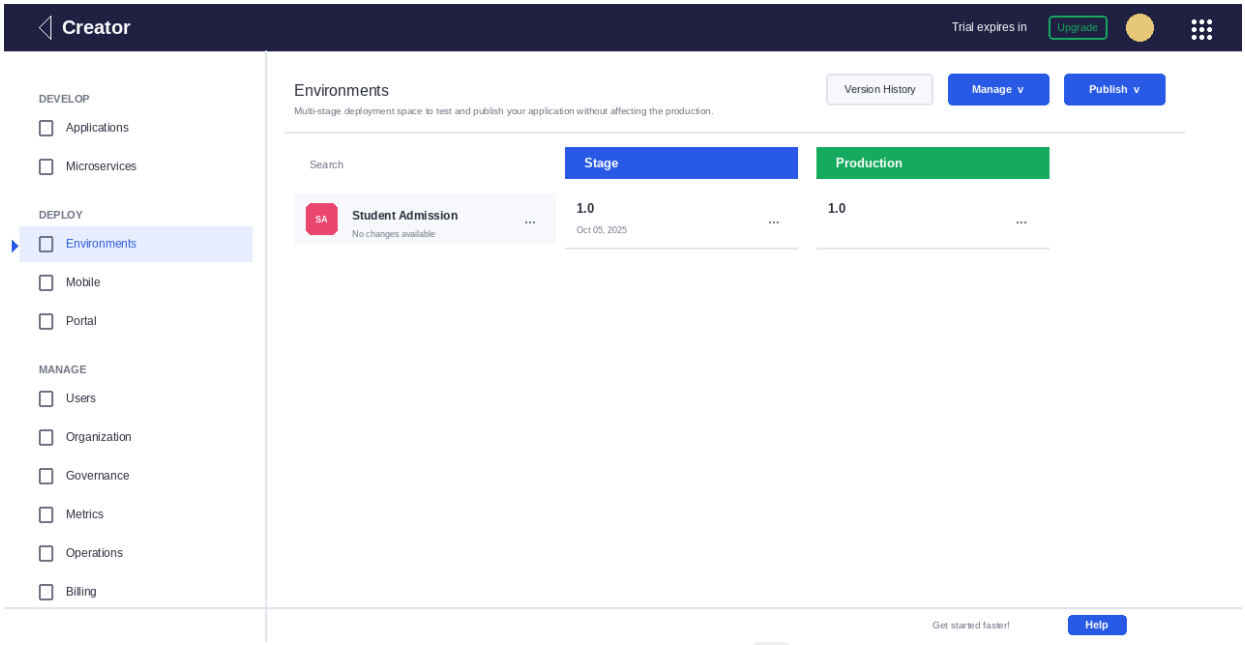


Figure 11.3: Environments Page – Student Admission Application Added (Version 1.0 in Stage and Production)

4. **Development environment:** the application is built and configured here. Its status is shown as *Deployed* with the description “Application configured and ready for deployment” (Sep 29, 2025, 10:15 AM).
5. **Stage environment:** the application is deployed to Stage, tested and approved. Its status is *Deployed* with the description “Application tested and approved in Stage” (Sep 29, 2025, 11:42 AM).
6. **Production environment:** after approval in Stage, the application is published to Production. The Production tab is selected, the Environment is Production and the status is **Live**, with the message “The application is published and live in Production.” The Deployment Progress panel shows Production as Live – “Application is live and accessible to end users” (Sep 30, 2025, 09:20 AM). Published by: You is also shown.

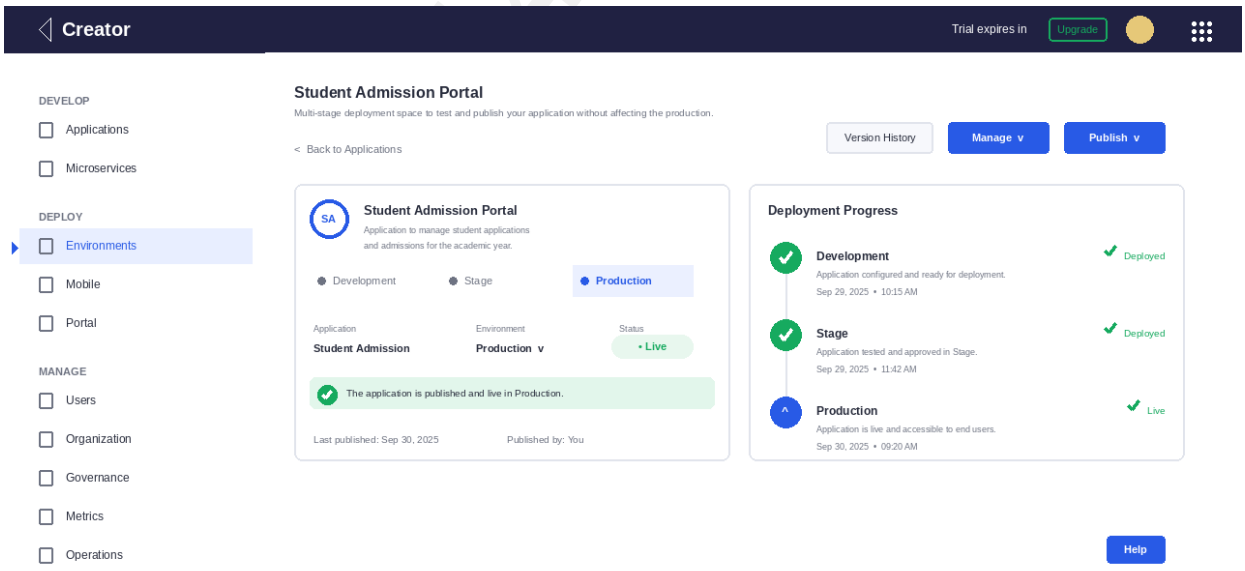


Figure 11.4: Deployment Progress – Student Admission Portal Live in Production (Illustrative)

Infrastructure Timeline

The progression of the application from inception to production rollout, as displayed in the Deployment Progress panel, is summarised below.

Stage	Environment	Status	Description Shown	Date and Time
1	Development	Deployed	Application configured and ready for deployment.	Sep 29, 2025 • 10:15 AM
2	Stage	Deployed	Application tested and approved in Stage.	Sep 29, 2025 • 11:42 AM
3	Production	Live	Application is live and accessible to end users.	Sep 30, 2025 • 09:20 AM

Result

The following were successfully carried out for the Student Admission Portal application:

- The Environments page under DEPLOY was accessed and the Stage and Production environments were studied.
- The Student Admission application was added to the environment (version 1.0 in Stage and Production).
- The application was configured in Development (Deployed – Sep 29, 2025, 10:15 AM).
- The application was tested and approved in Stage (Deployed – Sep 29, 2025, 11:42 AM).
- The application was published to Production and is Live for applicants (Sep 30, 2025, 09:20 AM).

Conclusion

The experiment explained how a Zoho Creator application moves from development to production through environments. The Student Admission Portal application was configured in Development, deployed to Stage where it was tested and approved, and then published to Production, where it became live and accessible to applicants, as recorded in the timeline from Sep 29, 2025 (10:15 AM) to Sep 30, 2025 (09:20 AM). This staged approach satisfies the testing framework expected of an enterprise release: isolation of work in progress, verification before release, a controlled and traceable promotion path, and Version History for review. It keeps the live admission process protected from untested changes and downtime, and makes releases controlled and traceable.

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